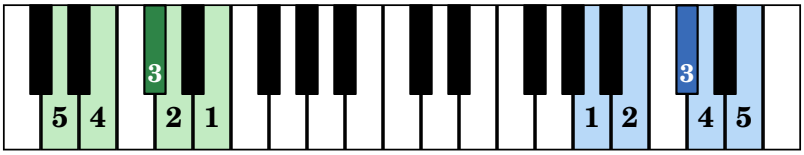
Unit 7

Three Sharps and Three Flats

New: A major, E-flat major, F-sharp minor and C minor

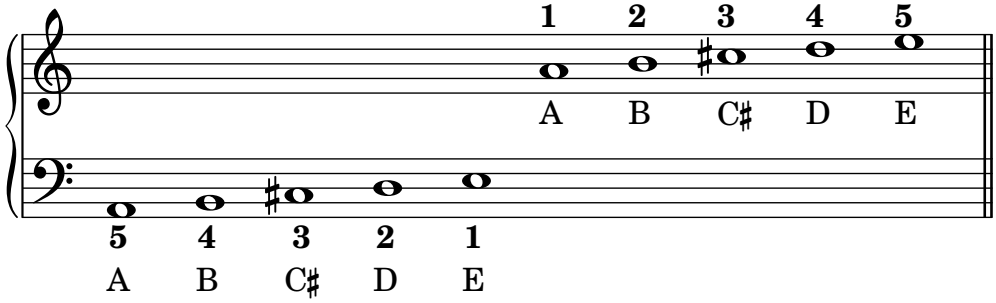
Two new major keys and their relative minors. A major has three sharps (F, C and G); its relative minor is F-sharp minor. E-flat major has three flats (B, E and A); its relative minor is C minor. Each new sharp or flat adds one black key to the hand positions you already know.

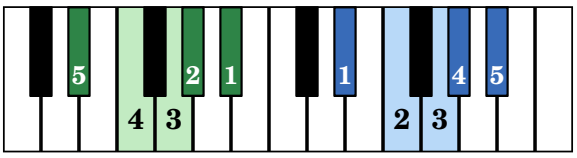


Middle C

Left hand A position and Right hand A position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes

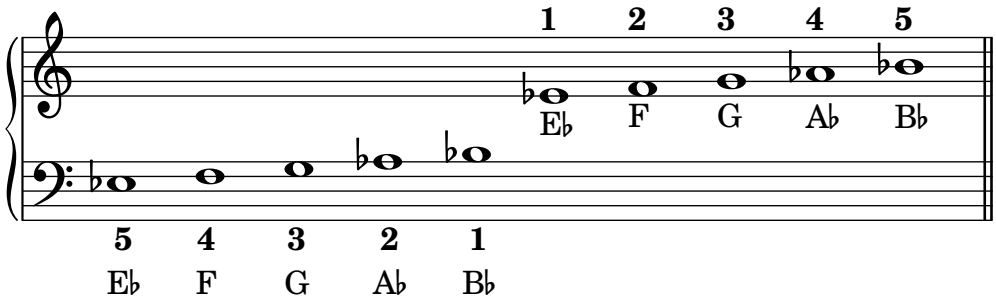




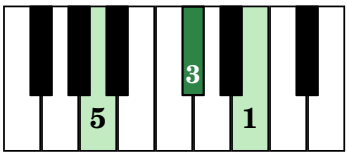
Middle C

Left hand E-flat position and Right hand E-flat position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

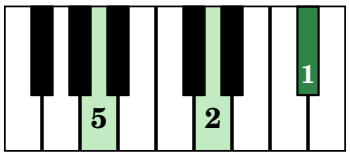
Your notes



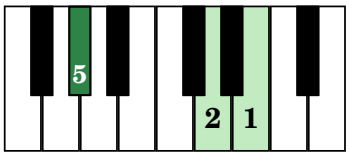
A major: left-hand chord shapes



I = A

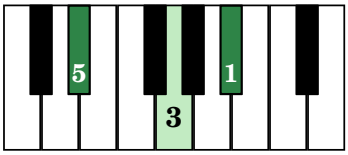


IV = D

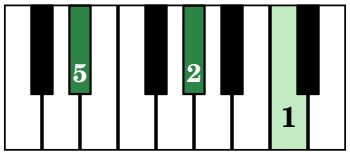


V7 = E7

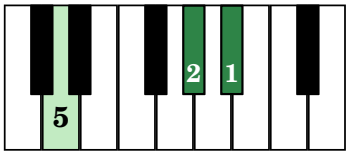
E-flat major: left-hand chord shapes



I = E♭

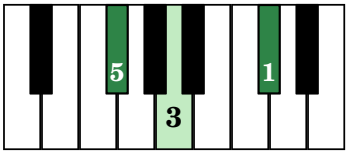


IV = A♭

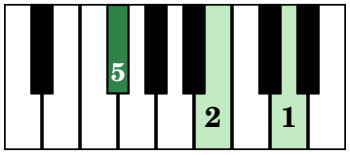


V7 = B♭7

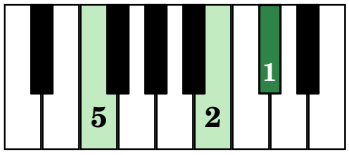
F-sharp minor: left-hand chord shapes



i = F♯m

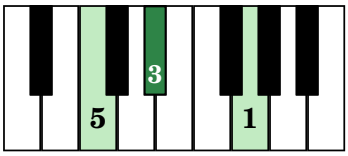


iv = Bm

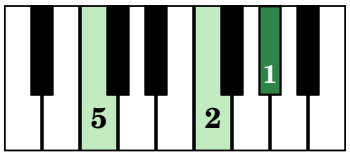


V7 = C♯7

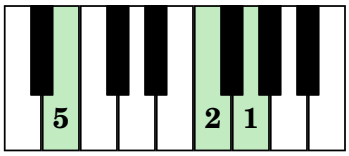
C minor: left-hand chord shapes



i = Cm

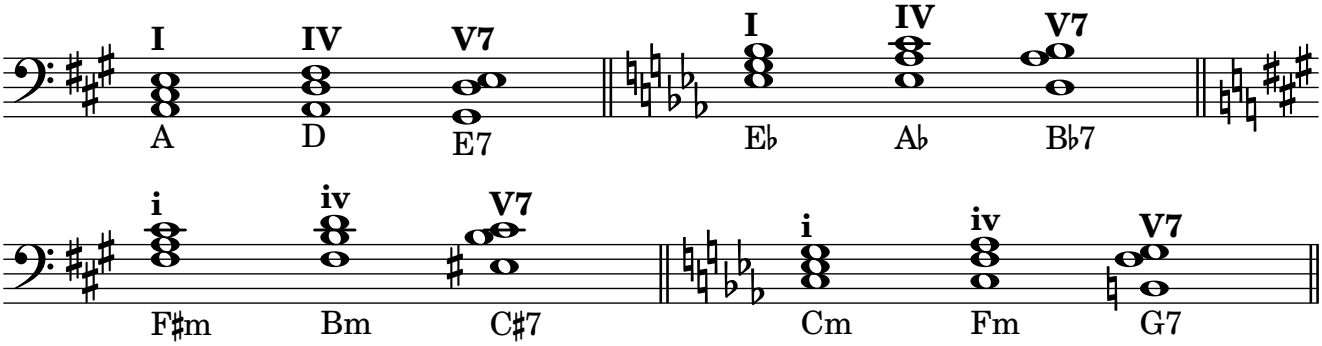


iv = Fm



V7 = G7

The same shapes on the staff



What is new

Three sharps, three flats

Sharps come in the order F C G (D A E B); flats in the order B E A (D G C F). The last sharp is the 7th note of the major key: G-sharp in A major. The second last flat names the key: E-flat.

F-sharp minor: E-sharp

The raised 7th of F-sharp minor is E-sharp, which is the white key F. It looks strange but is just the key below F-sharp.

C minor: B-natural

The raised 7th of C minor is B-natural: the key signature has B-flat, so the accidental is a natural sign.

Reading tips

1. Before you play, name the three sharps or flats and touch those keys with the right fingers.
2. In the minor keys, expect the accidental (E-sharp or B-natural) in V7 bars.
3. E-sharp and B-sharp, C-flat and F-flat are white keys: read the note name, then trust your hand.

Part A: A major ♩ = 60

A major with an Alberti bass. G-sharp is the bottom note of the V7 shape.

☐ **7.1**



☐ **7.2**



7.3



7.4



7.5



7.6



7.7



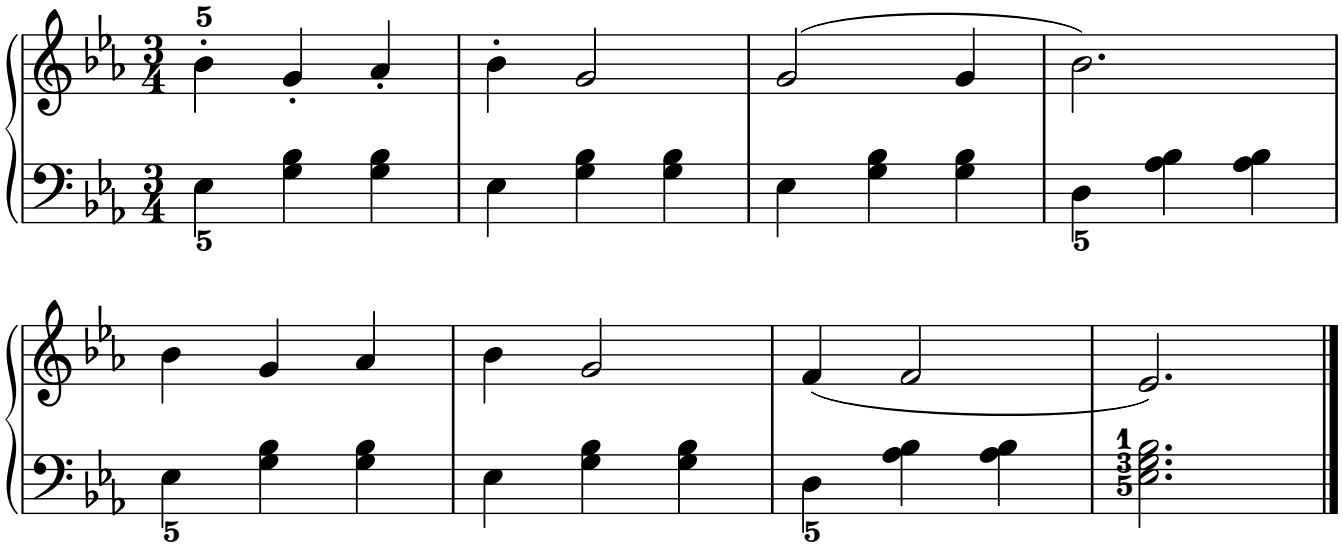
7.8



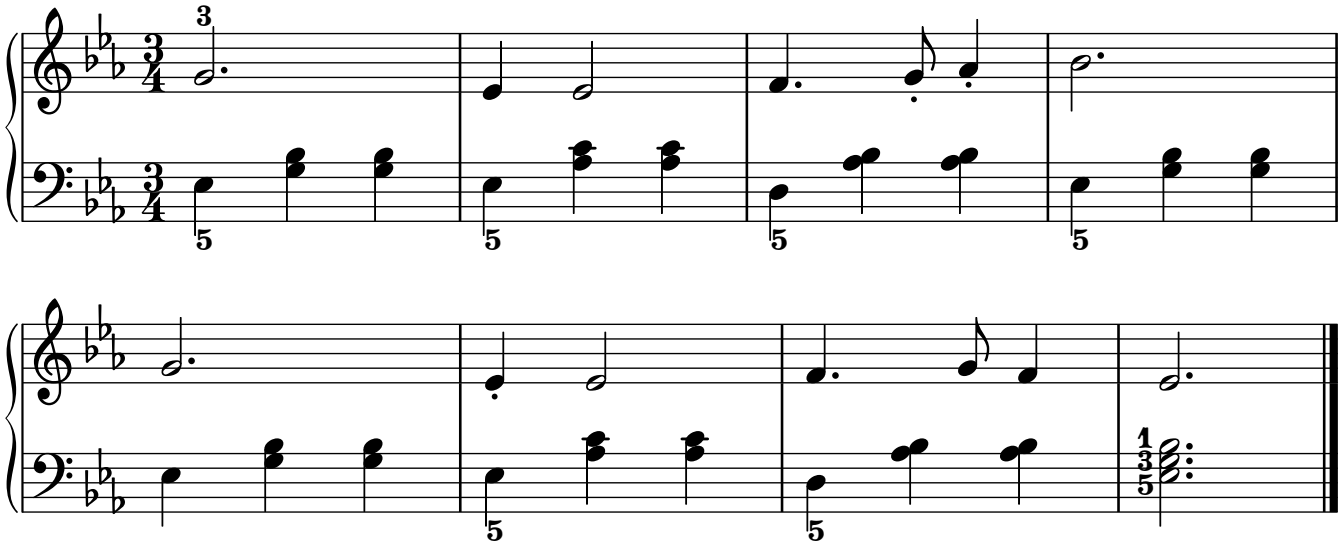
Part B: E-flat major waltz ♩ = 80

E-flat major waltzes. The thumb of the right hand sits on E-flat.

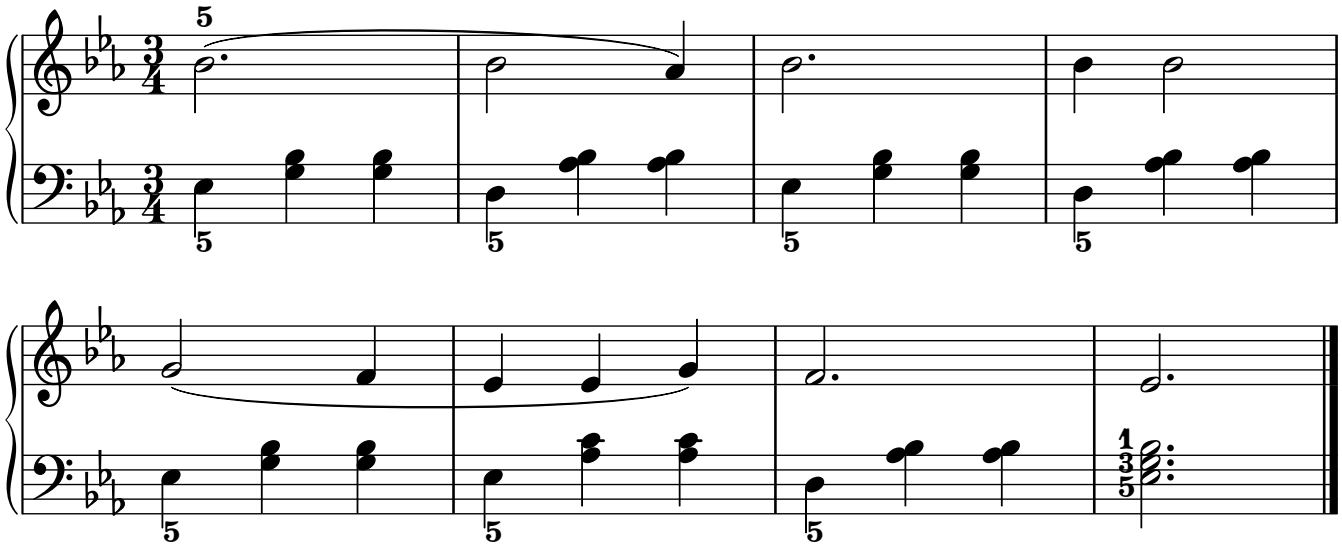
☐ **7.9**



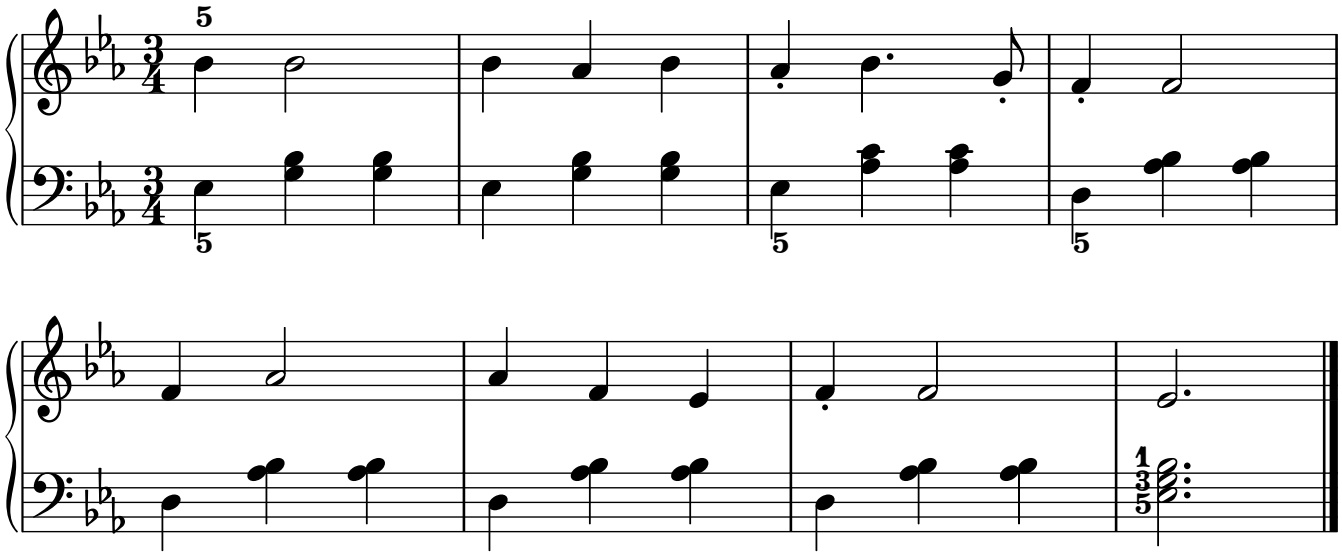
☐ **7.10**



☐ **7.11**



☐ **7.12**



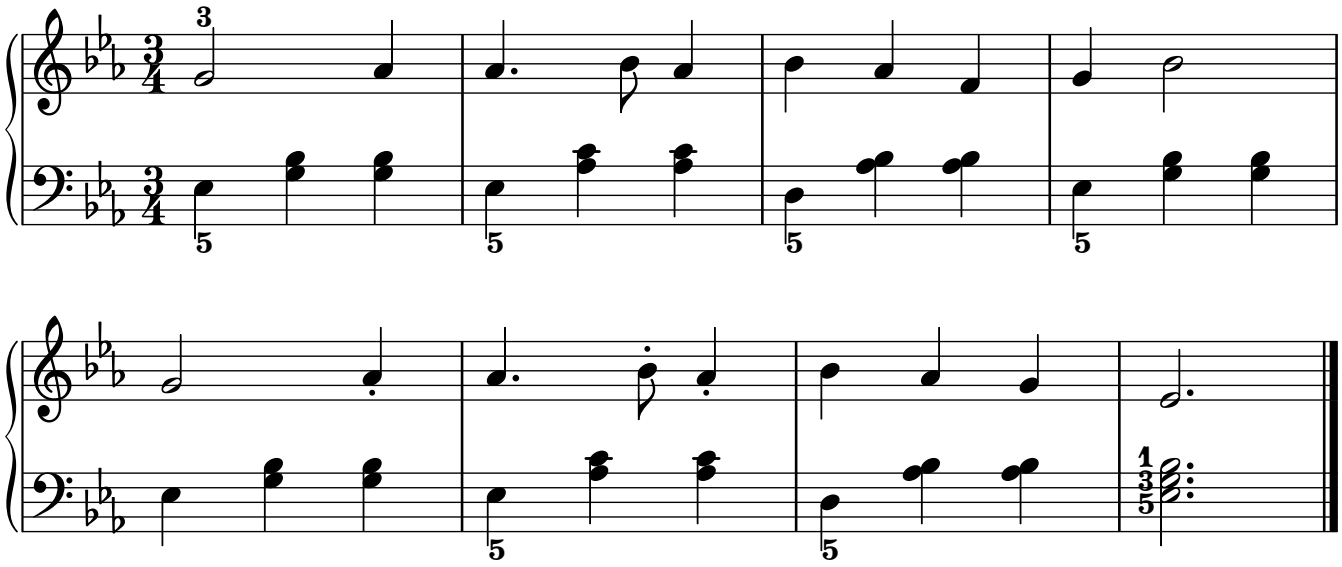
☐ **7.13**



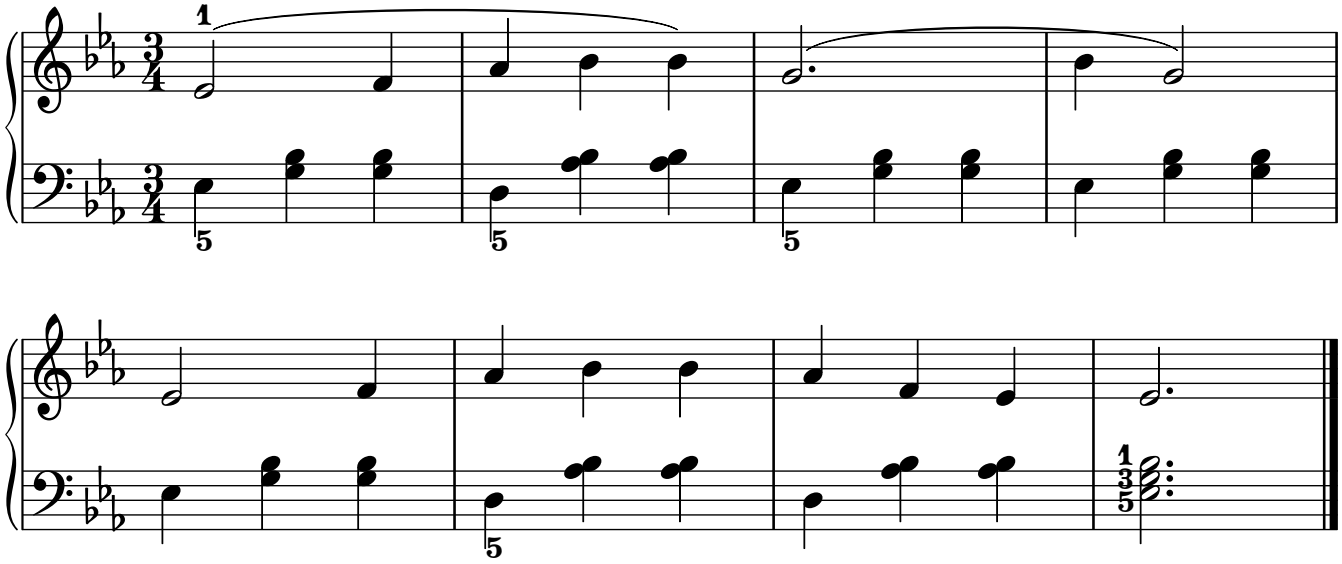
☐ **7.14**



7.15



7.16

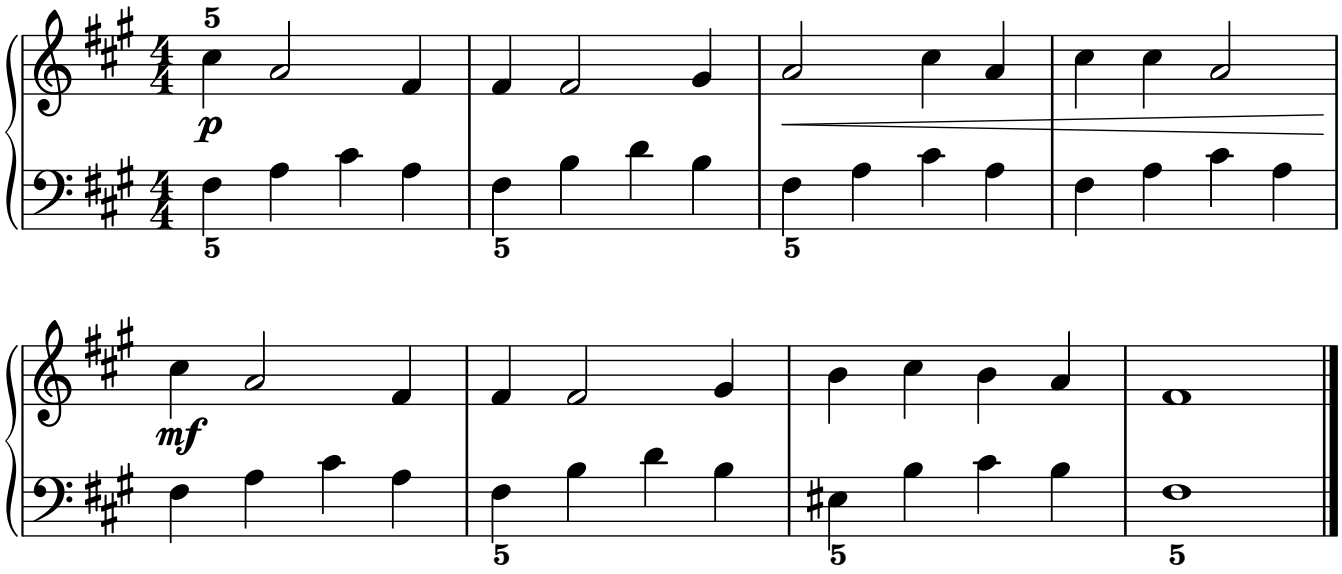


Part C: F-sharp minor: E-sharp

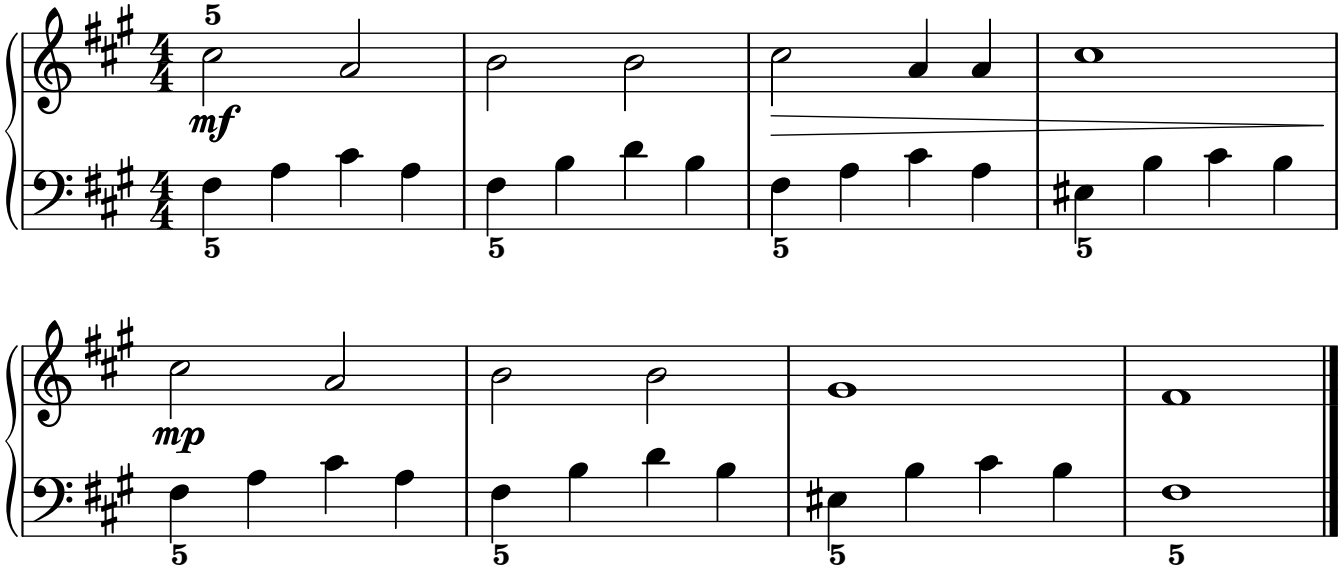
♩ = 60

F-sharp minor: E-sharp (a white key) in the V7 bars.

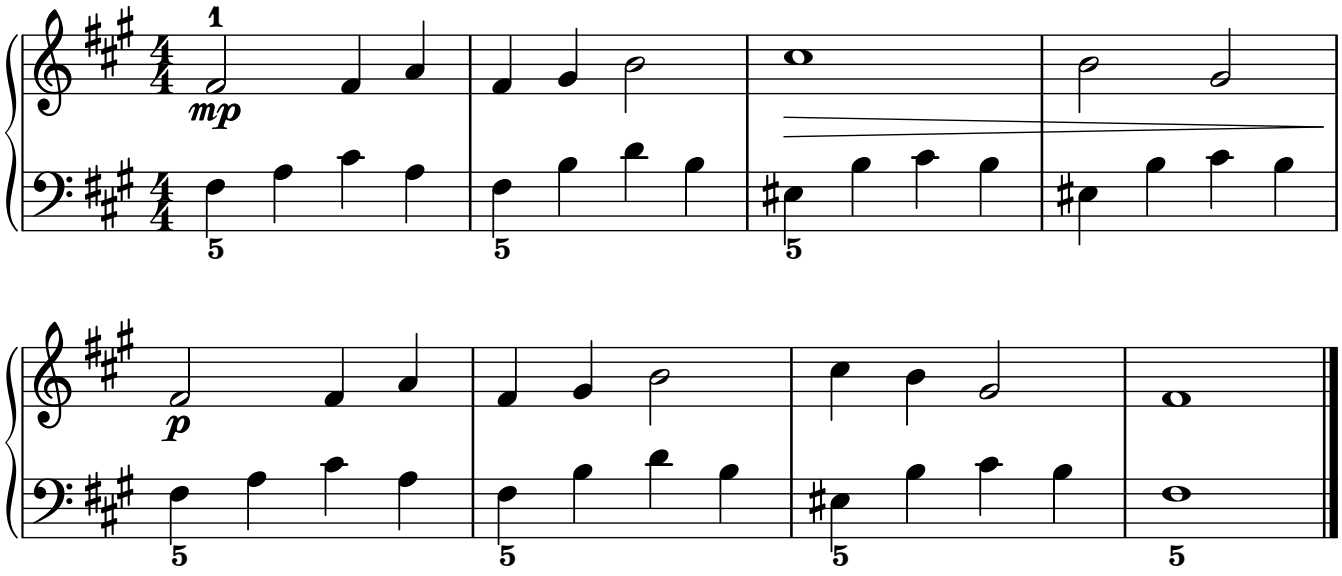
☐ **7.17**



☐ **7.18**



☐ **7.19**



☐ **7.20**



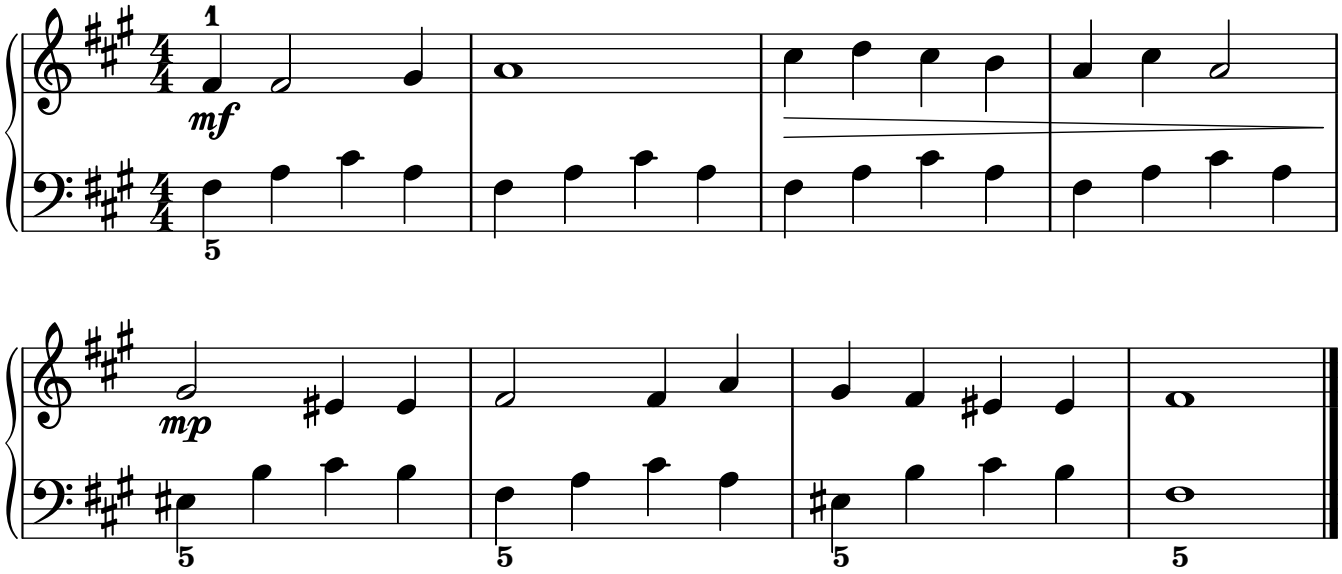
☐ **7.21**



7.22



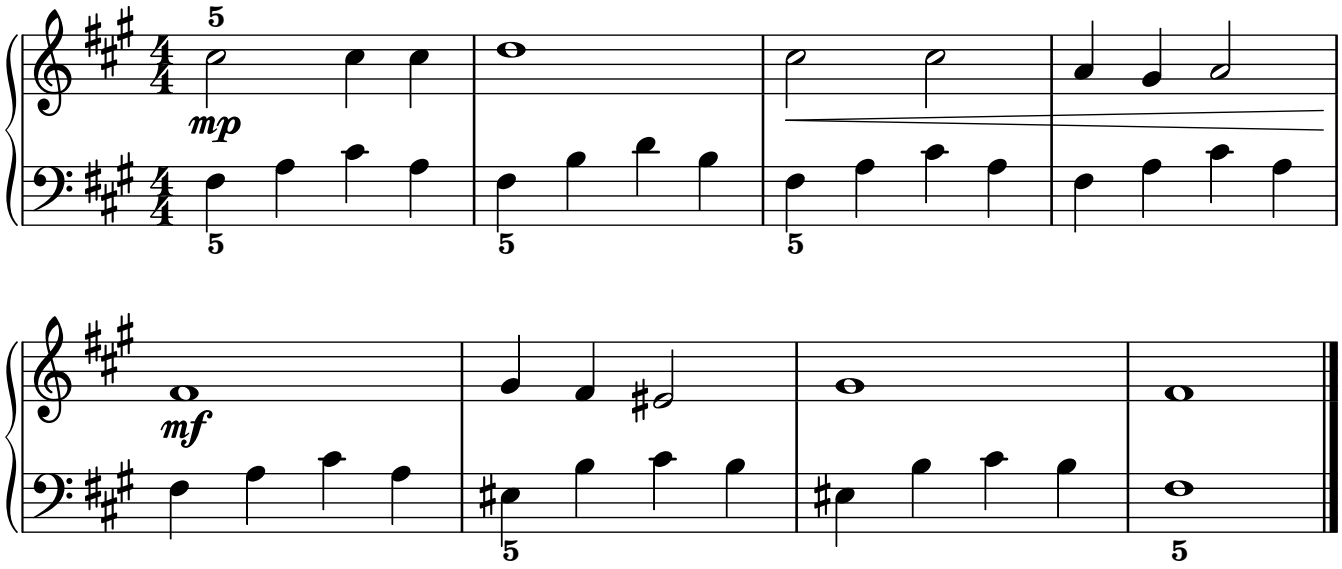
7.23



7.24



7.25



Part D: C minor: B-natural ♩ = 66

C minor with an oom-pah bass: B-natural in the V7 bars.

☐ **7.26**



☐ **7.27**



7.28



7.29



7.30



7.31



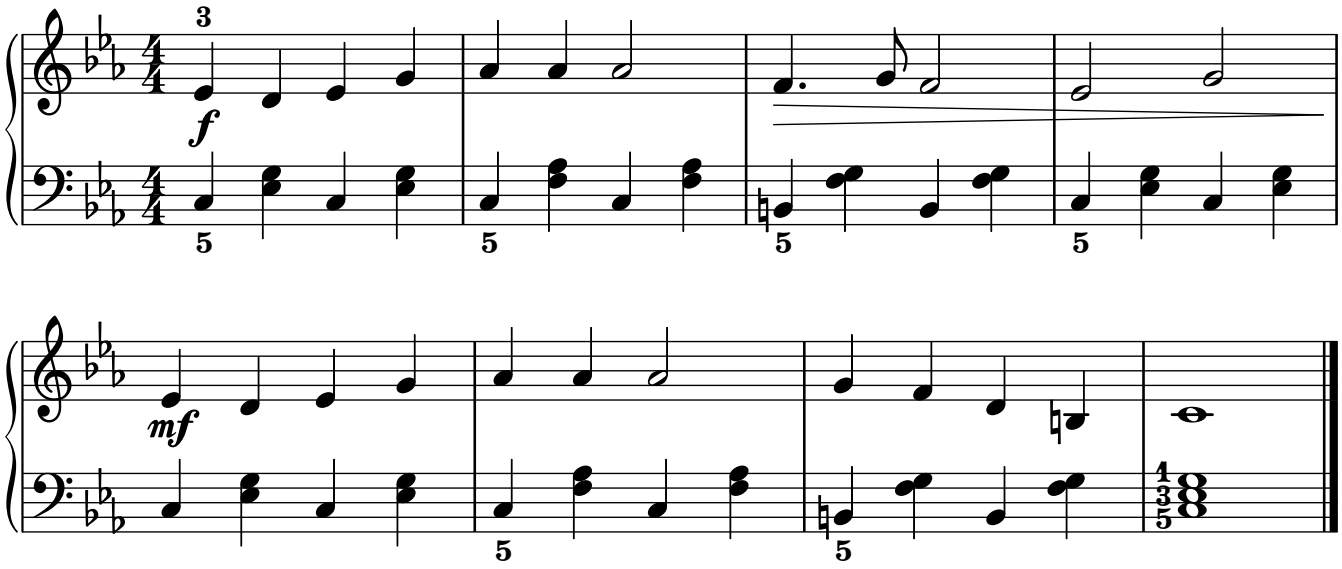
7.32



7.33



7.34



Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Minuet in C minor ♩ = 92

From the Notebook for Anna Magdalena Bach, BWV Anh. 121 - first part

High in the right hand, low in the left. Three accidentals: B-natural (the raised 7th) in bar 7, and E-natural (right hand) and A-natural (left hand) in bar 5, which lean briefly towards F minor. The trill in bar 4 is left out. Source: Mutopia Project no. 1613.



Spring in A ♩ = 72

Original

A major over an Alberti bass. C-sharp and F-sharp are in the right hand's position; G-sharp comes in bars 3 and 7, where the thumb stretches down to it.



E-flat Waltz ♩ = 120

Original

Three flats: B-flat, E-flat and A-flat. Both hands start with a finger on E-flat; in bar 7 the right-hand thumb stretches down to D.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 8?

- Play two new exercises from each part at the speeds shown: at most one stop each, 9 notes out of 10 right.
- Name the key of each exercise before you start, and play every sharp, flat and accidental.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 8.